

EXPANSION - TRAINER CARDS

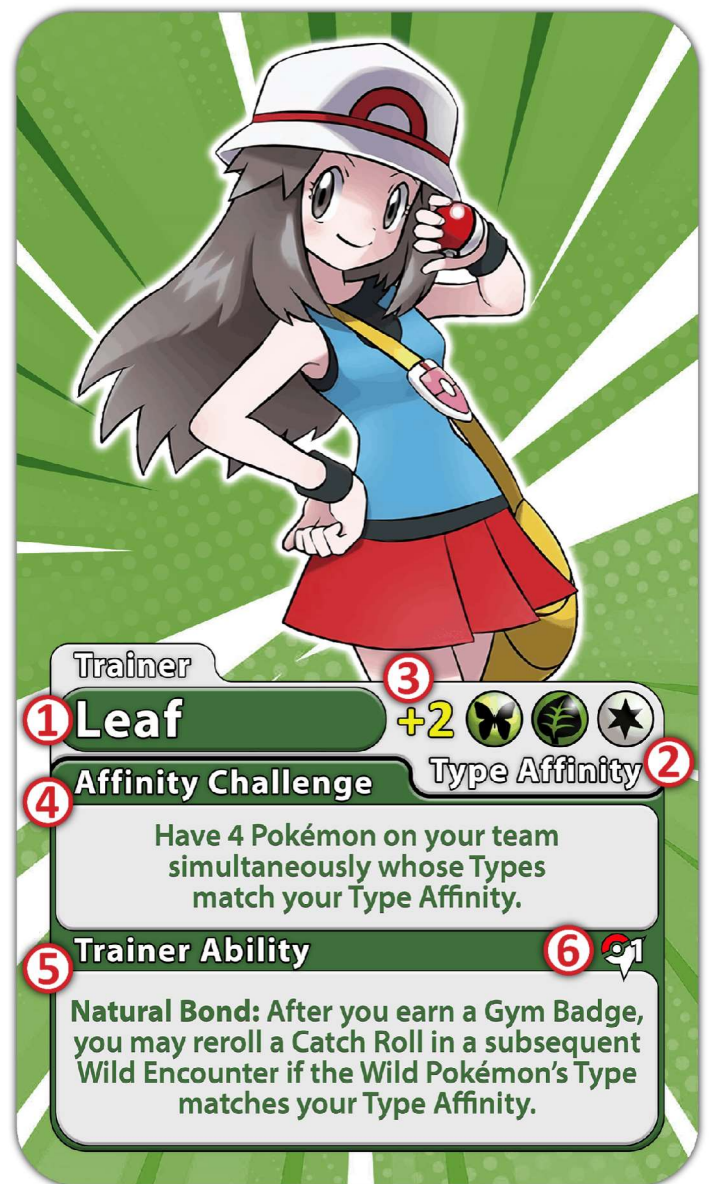
In recent years, many board games have begun incorporating character sheets, chosen at the start of a game, that give each player a unique set of stats and abilities. Games like *Mansions of Madness*, *Battlestar: Galactica*, and *Gloomhaven* all have this style of game mechanic to varying degrees, and the design space is there to bring it to PMTU as well.

Inspired by a post on the PMTU Discord by Davilson, Trainer cards are an optional add-on that can give each player a unique ability or action they can take on their turn, an optional goal they can work to complete during the game, and a bonus they can unlock for certain Types of Pokémon if they complete that goal.

TRAINER CARD OVERVIEW

Each Trainer card looks similar to Leaf, shown to the right.

- 1 TRAINER NAME:** The Trainer's name.
- 2 TYPE AFFINITY:** The three Types this Trainer specializes in. A Trainer's Type Affinity can be utilized in various ways, usually in the form of the Trainer's Affinity Bonus (see below).
- Some Affinity Challenges or Trainer Abilities may reference the Type Affinity as well. As an example, Leaf's Affinity Challenge compares the Types of all of her Pokémon to her Type Affinity, and as soon as the the challenge's condition is fulfilled (meaning, as soon as four of the Pokémon on her team have some combination of *Bug*, *Grass*, and *Normal* Types between them), the Affinity Bonus is unlocked.
- 3 AFFINITY BONUS:** This number is added to a Pokémon's Attack Total when it uses a Move that matches the Trainer's Type Affinity. The bonus is unlocked by completing the Affinity Challenge.
- 4 AFFINITY CHALLENGE:** An optional goal the player can complete in order to unlock their Affinity Bonus. Some Affinity Challenges are complete as soon as you complete a specific action, such as "Defeat the Region's Villainous Organization." Others may take repeated efforts over multiple turns to complete, such as "Play a Catch Card 6 times." If you need to track your progress over time, you can use one or more **d6** as needed.



- 5 TRAINER ABILITY:** Each Trainer has an ability they can use, usually during their own turn. They may be unique actions the player can take in or out of Battle, or they might augment other game actions or trigger when certain actions are taken.
- 6 ABILITY SYMBOLS:** Trainer Abilities fall into a few different categories, denoted by the symbol here. Some of these symbols confer additional rules on how the ability is used (shown on the next page).

ABILITY ICONS

The different symbols you might see to the right of a Trainer Ability are listed here. Some are purely informational, while others carry additional rules that affect how you may use an ability.



ONCE PER GYM: Indicates that this Trainer Ability gains one "charge" the moment you earn a Gym Badge. At any time before you earn your next Gym Badge, you may use the ability at the appropriate time, spending the charge to do so. If you would earn a second charge while you already have one, the extra charge is lost.



ONCE PER BATTLE: Indicates that this Trainer Ability gains one "charge" at the beginning of a Battle. During that Battle, you may use the ability at the appropriate time, spending the charge to do so. Any remaining charges are lost the moment the Battle ends.



AUGMENTATION: Indicates that this Trainer Ability improves the capabilities of yourself or your Pokémon in some way, usually under specific conditions.



HANDICAP: Indicates that this Trainer Ability limits the capabilities of yourself or your Pokémon in some way, usually under specific conditions. These effects are usually temporary and are balanced by an Affinity Challenge that can be completed earlier than normal or by a higher Affinity Bonus.



ADDITIONAL EFFECT: Indicates that this Trainer Ability adds an additional effect to another game action or event.

USING TRAINER CARDS

While you are setting up to play, after you have gathered your Trainer Figure and Current Home tokens but before you choose your starter Pokémon, each player chooses a Trainer Card.

OPTIONAL: Rather than have each player choose a Trainer Card, you may shuffle them up and have each player in turn draw one at random.

Whatever your group's method for distributing the cards amongst the players, once you have your Trainer Card, place it next to your Pokémon Rack. The player who received their Trainer Card last gets to be the first to choose a starter Pokémon.

OPTIONAL: At your group's discretion, each player's starter Pokémon must share at least one Type with their Trainer's Type Affinity.

Unless otherwise specified, Trainer Abilities outside of Battle may only be used on your own turn, and Trainer Abilities that are used in Battle may only be used in a Battle where you are either the Attacker or Defender. (In other words, you can't affect a Battle happening between two other players.)

MULTIPLES OF ONE CHARACTER

Some characters may appear on both Trainer cards and Gym Leader or Rival cards, such as Blue or May. At your group's discretion, you could choose to omit Trainer cards for characters who appear on other cards in the Region you are playing in, or you could choose to keep them in. After all, who can say for sure that another Blue didn't get sucked through an Ultra Wormhole or fall into a Hoopa's portal to get here?

DIFFICULTY ADJUSTMENTS

Trainer cards can affect the difficulty by virtue of the large Affinity Bonus most characters will unlock in the mid-to-late game. To account for this, you can adjust the Level of a Gym Leader, Villainous Organization, or Rival's Pokémon in the following ways.

CARD TYPE	ADJUSTMENT
Gym Leader Tier 1 - 3, Pink and Green Rivals	No Change
Gym Leader Tier 4 - 6, Villainous Organization, Blue Rivals	+1 Level
Gym Leader Tier 7 - 8, Elite Four, Champion, Yellow and Red Rivals	+2 Levels